



THE BUDDHA VILLA RETREAT

A guided plant medicine journey.

Love · Happiness · Freedom

CAPE TOWN · SOUTH AFRICA

*"The medicine opens
the door.*

*What you bring
to it shapes what
walks *through*."*

— CHENEY, FOUNDER

THIS GUIDE

*A document to **sit** with. Not skim.*

It walks slowly through the Buddha Villa Retreat: what brings people, what the medicine asks, how the week is held, what happens before and after.

Read it the way you would prepare for the journey itself. Slowly.
With attention.

01

THE QUESTION

*Before the door, the
question.*

SIT WITH THIS FOR A MOMENT

Are you looking for clarity, or healing?

Most people come for one of the two. Most discover, somewhere in the week, that they came for both.

The answer is not a label. It is a signal. It indicates a lot about how the journey will unfold for you, what the ceremonies will surface, and what integration will ask of you on the other side.

THE FIRST JOURNEY

If you came for clarity.

The fog is the problem. You have outgrown a chapter and can't yet see the next one. A decision is waiting. A direction is asking to be named. A purpose feels close, but not close enough to hold.

The clarity journey is about cutting through. Ceremony tends to bring it sharp and quiet. You leave with fewer questions, not more answers, but the questions you keep are the right ones.

WHAT THE JOURNEY OFTEN SURFACES

A direction you'd been avoiding naming.

A truth about a relationship or commitment.

A purpose that has been there all along.

A decision the body already knew.

THE SECOND JOURNEY

If you came for healing.

Something is held in the body that the mind has not been able to move. Grief that did not get to grieve. A relationship that did not get to be named. A version of yourself you had to abandon to survive.

The healing journey is slower and quieter than people expect. Ceremony does not push. It opens, and what needs to come up comes up. The work is in being present for it, and being held while it moves.

WHAT THE JOURNEY OFTEN SURFACES

A grief never properly named.

A pattern in relationships that keeps repeating.

A part of yourself you have not forgiven.

An old fear the body is finally ready to release.

THE TWO JOURNEYS

*In time, the two **become** the **same**.*

Most who come for clarity find that the fog was a wound. Most who come for healing find clarity waiting on the other side of the work.

You do not need to know which one you are here for. You only need to be honest about which one you started with. The medicine and the framework will hold the rest.

The signal matters more than the label. What you tell us in screening shapes how your week is held, the support you are paired with, and the integration we offer afterward.

*"You arrive
carrying.
You leave
clearer."*

— A GUEST FROM A PAST COHORT

02

THE SETTING

A villa briefed for one purpose.

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CAMPS BAY · CAPE TOWN

THE BUDDHA VILLA

*The Atlantic on one side. The mountains on the **other**.*

A private villa set against the Twelve Apostles in Camps Bay.
Communal spaces, private rooms, outdoor decks, a pool that opens onto the ocean. The villa is fully briefed and held. There is no friction, no logistics, nothing to manage.

Guests arrive and the only thing asked of them is presence. The space takes care of everything else.

Twelve people. One house. One shared week.

Small enough that every person is seen, held, and known by name through the week.

*The room is built.
The week is held.
The only thing
asked of you
is to arrive.*

03

THE MEDICINE

*The door,
and what it asks of you.*

THE APPROACH

Plant medicine is a doorway. Not a destination.

The Foundation treats plant medicine with the seriousness it deserves. It is not recreational. It is not a shortcut. It is a tool that, held properly, can dissolve the defences a person has spent decades building, and let them see what is underneath.

The medicine does the opening. The work is what you do with the door once it is open. That work happens in the teaching, the fire circles, the silence, and the integration. The ceremony is one part of a much larger container.

The medicine doesn't give answers. It removes what was in the way of seeing them. The seeing is yours to do.

THE CONTAINER

How the space is held.

Plant medicine is only as safe as the container around it. The Foundation builds that container deliberately, in four layers.

01 *Screening before acceptance*

Every guest is screened for medical and psychological fit. The medicine is not right for everyone, and the Foundation says so when it isn't.

02 *Experienced facilitation*

Ceremonies are led by experienced practitioners. Guests are never alone with the experience. Support is present through every hour.

03 *A small, known cohort*

Twelve guests, no more. Small enough that the facilitators know what each person is carrying, and can hold accordingly.

04 *Framework before and after*

Preparation in the weeks before. Integration in the weeks after. The ceremony sits inside a structure, never on its own.

*A doorway,
not a destination.*

— ON THE MEDICINE

04

THE JOURNEY

Six days, built as an arc.

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SUNDAY THROUGH FRIDAY

THE SIX-DAY ARC

Three ceremonies, woven into a structure that *builds*.

SUNDAY <i>Arrival</i> Settling in. Purpose and alignment. The first night is about landing. ORIENTATION	MONDAY <i>First ceremony</i> Emotional intelligence by day. The door opens at night. CEREMONY 01	TUESDAY <i>Second ceremony</i> The work goes to what the first ceremony surfaced. CEREMONY 02	WEDNESDAY <i>Third ceremony</i> The deepest day. Held with the most care. CEREMONY 03	THURSDAY <i>Application</i> Practical integration. The fire circle. FIRE CIRCLE	FRIDAY <i>Closing</i> Closing circle and departure with an integration plan. DEPARTURE
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Ceremonies are not stacked back to back. Each is followed by a day of teaching and rest so the body and mind can metabolise before the next.

A DAY IN THE RHYTHM

The hours between the ceremonies.

*06:30***Sit before the day arrives.**

Twenty minutes of stillness. No phones.

*08:00***Yoga and movement.**

Bodywork before the mind shows up.

*10:00***Teaching, a pillar in depth.**

Group work. Real conversations.

*13:00***Long table lunch.**

Food cooked at the villa. The community forms here.

*15:00***A long walk, mostly in silence.**

The morning's work settles.

*19:00***Fire circle, or ceremony.**

Depending on the day. The centre of the week.

Rest is not a gap in the programme. It is part of the programme. The work needs space to land.

By the third day, most guests stop checking the time. The rhythm carries them. That is the point.

THE THREE CEREMONIES

*Each one goes **further** than the last.*

01 *Monday — meeting yourself*

The first ceremony is about contact. Most guests meet a version of themselves they have been avoiding. The facilitators hold steady. Nothing is forced.

02 *Tuesday — moving through it*

The second ceremony builds on the first. With the door already open, the work goes deeper into what the first ceremony surfaced. Often the hardest night, and the most important.

03 *Wednesday — letting it settle*

The third ceremony is held with the most care. It is less about opening and more about integration, about beginning to carry what was found back into the body.

*"Between every ceremony,
the space to **metabolise**
what was found."*

— ON THE RHYTHM OF THE WEEK

05

THE ARC BEYOND THE WEEK

*The retreat is six days.
The **work** is longer.*

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PREPARATION · INTEGRATION · COMPANION

BEFORE YOU ARRIVE

*Preparation begins **weeks** out.*

What a guest brings to the ceremony shapes what the ceremony can do. So the work starts before arrival. In the weeks leading up, guests are guided to slow down: eat lighter, sleep more, sit quietly, pay attention to what they are carrying.

The Foundation provides a structured preparation guide, and a companion, in the weeks before.

Preparation is the first ceremony. The week at the villa simply continues what the preparation begins.

AFTER YOU LEAVE

*Integration is where the lesson becomes a *life*.*

Guests leave with an integration plan. Slow mornings, journaling, breathwork, walks, conversations. The ceremony opens the door. Integration walks you through it. This is where the real change holds or fades.

NAVID, the companion.

Every guest gets access to NAVID, the Foundation's companion. Trained on the seven pillars and the rhythm of a retreat, it holds the space between sessions, through preparation, and long into integration.

The Foundation does not disappear on Friday. Integration support and the companion carry the work for as long as the guest needs it.

*The medicine opens
the door.*

*You walk **through**.*

*The Foundation
walks **with** you.*

– THE LOVE HAPPINESS FREEDOM FOUNDATION



A GUIDE TO THE JOURNEY

The Buddha Villa Retreat.

Take this with you. Sit with it. The next step finds you when
it is yours to take.

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